

Classical Dance & Music Traditions

Recognized classical dances and Hindustani/Carnatic basics.

Portion focus ~28% · Topic: culture-perf

PYQ themes: Classical dances · Music schools · Instruments

Why UPSC asks this

Intermittent but syllabus-important matching questions.

Dance

State/region association + one distinctive feature (storytelling style, costume, music).

Music

Raga/tala idea; gharanas at light touch; folk vs classical boundary questions.

Must remember

- Bharatanatyam, Kathak, Kathakali, Odissi, Kuchipudi, Sattriya, Manipuri, Mohiniyattam
- Hindustani vs Carnatic high-level contrast